

THE 5 MONEY TRAPS CHECKLIST

Five questions that stop your money leaking away



THE SUNK COST TRAP

Check: *Am I still paying for something I would never buy again today?*

Fix: If the answer is no, quit it. Spent money is gone — stop paying twice.



THE ANCHOR TRAP

Check: *Am I buying this because of the crossed-out 'was' price?*

Fix: Ignore the anchor. Compare the price against real alternatives, not the fake original.



THE DIDEROT TRAP

Check: *Did one new purchase 'need' matching purchases?*

Fix: One new thing should never trigger five. Buy the item, not the lifestyle.



THE PARKINSON TRAP

Check: *Did my spending grow with my last raise?*

Fix: Cap your lifestyle at the old level and save the difference automatically.



THE 80/20 MONEY LEAK

Check: *Do I know which 20% of my spending causes 80% of my money stress?*

Fix: Track every dollar for 7 days. Cut the top leak first.